

Judgement

Fear, Word, and Prosody

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The word arrives before you understand it.

Fear two syllables,
the first one holds its breath.
The second lets go.

The card shows bodies rising from the ground.
Not ascending *rising*.
The difference is gravity.

The trumpet sounds once
and the word is already in you
before the sound.

Prosody is the body of language
the weight of syllables,
the place where the breath breaks.

Fear breaks at the *ea*.
The mouth opens.
Something gets in.

Every word has a prosodic ground state:
the configuration of lowest breath.

Love one syllable, no break,
the mouth closes at the end.

Fear stays open.

Death stops mid-breath, the *th*
like a door that won't latch.

Now the mouth rounds,
the word curves back into the body.

The Judgement card is not about verdict.

It is about recognition
the moment the word
and the thing
become the same weight.

You hear the trumpet
and you do not think *trumpet*.
You rise.

This is what fear does:
it makes the word and the thing
the same weight
before you consent.

The trumpet does not ask.

The word does not ask.

Both enter through the open vowel.

To speak without fear is to
choose the weight of each syllable
to break the breath
where you decide,
not where the word decides for you.

Prosody is sovereignty.

The rest is weather.